

MERRITT DIGITAL · ALAMEDA

Your website, in your hands

Everything you need to put your new site online, on hosting you own outright — and to stop paying a monthly subscription for a website you already own.

Prepared for Dave · Oudkempeet Eetcafé · oudkempeetcafe.nl

0. Before you start

This guide takes you from nothing to a live website on hosting that belongs to you. When you finish, three things are true: **your website is yours, the hosting account is in your name, and you have no website subscription to pay.**

Most café websites cost their owner a monthly fee forever, for a site that was built once and rarely changes. That is what we are ending here. Come back to us whenever you want changes made — we would like you to, and we would rather earn it than lock you in.

Set aside about 45 minutes

Most of that is waiting. The clicking is perhaps fifteen minutes.

Have these ready

- **The website folder we sent you.** Save it somewhere you can find it — your Desktop is perfect. Do not open or rename anything inside it.
- **Your phone,** for the security code step.

- **Your login for the company you bought** `oudkempeneetcafe.nl` **from.** Your domain is registered through **Key-Systems**, possibly via a reseller you bought it from. You need to be able to sign in there for Step 4.
- **A printer or a pen.** There is one thing in Step 1 you must write down.

What will *not* happen

Your email will not be affected. We checked: there is no email attached to this domain — your Gmail address is entirely separate and nothing in this guide touches it. Your Google Maps listing and your reviews are also unaffected.

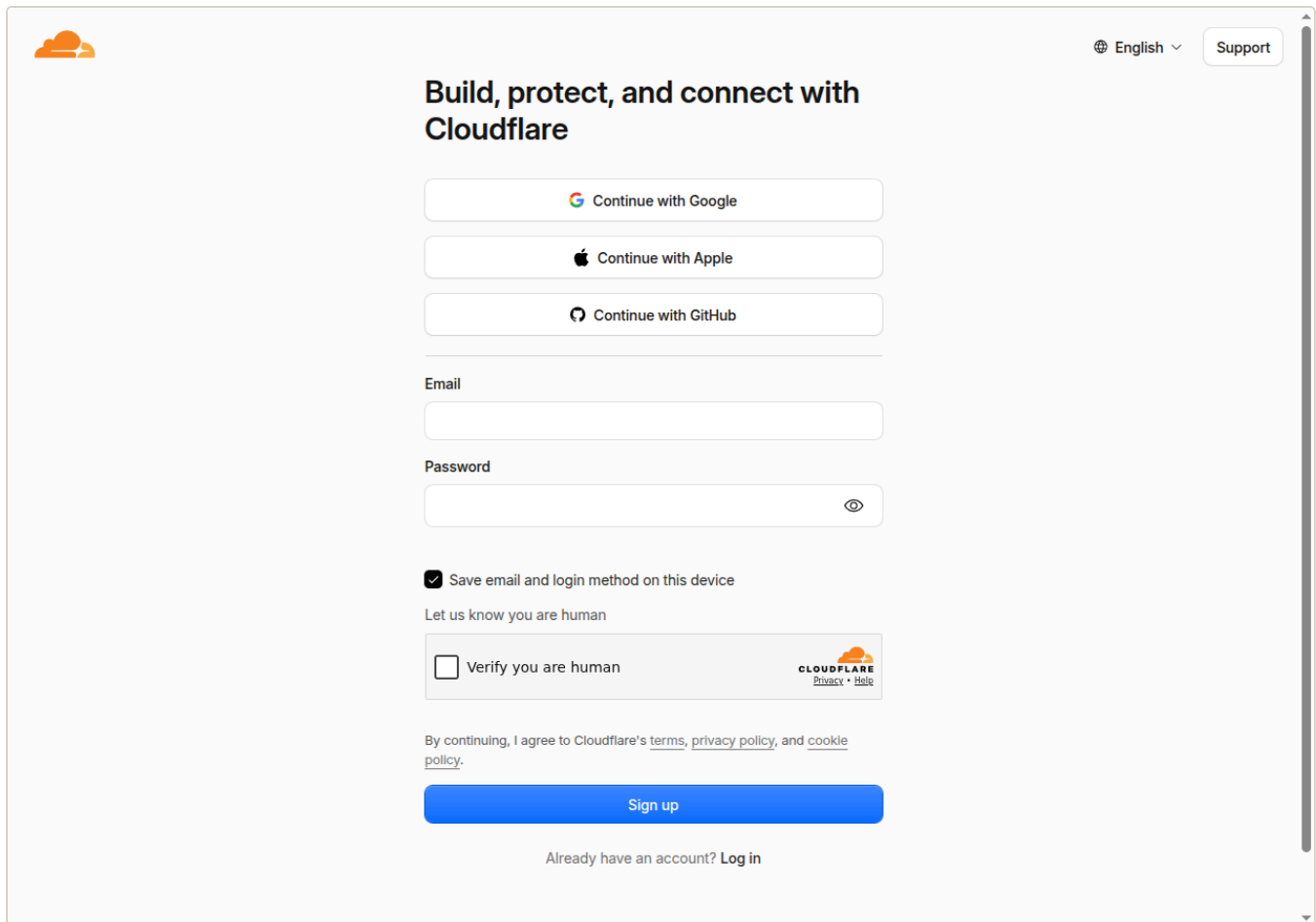
1. Create your Cloudflare account

Cloudflare is the company that will host your website. The plan we are using is free, and it stays free at the size of a café website.

1.1 — Open the sign-up page

In your browser, go to:

`dash.cloudflare.com/sign-up`

A screenshot of the Cloudflare sign-up page. At the top left is the Cloudflare logo. At the top right are links for 'English' and 'Support'. The main heading is 'Build, protect, and connect with Cloudflare'. Below this are three buttons: 'Continue with Google', 'Continue with Apple', and 'Continue with GitHub'. Underneath these are input fields for 'Email' and 'Password'. The 'Password' field has an eye icon to toggle visibility. Below the password field is a checkbox labeled 'Save email and login method on this device'. Then, the text 'Let us know you are human' is followed by a checkbox labeled 'Verify you are human'. To the right of this checkbox is the Cloudflare logo and links for 'Privacy' and 'Help'. Below this is a line of text: 'By continuing, I agree to Cloudflare's terms, privacy policy, and cookie policy.' At the bottom is a large blue 'Sign up' button. Below the button is a link: 'Already have an account? Log in'.

The sign-up page. Use the Email and Password boxes in the middle.

Type your email address and choose a password. Tick **“Verify you are human”**, then click the blue **Sign up** button.

Ignore the “Continue with Google / Apple / GitHub” buttons at the top — using a plain email address keeps this account simple and independent.

1.2 — Confirm your email

Cloudflare sends you an email with a confirmation link. Open it and click the link. If it has not arrived after a minute, check your spam folder.

1.3 — Turn on the security code, and write down your backup codes

Cloudflare will ask you to set up two-factor authentication — a six-digit code from your phone that you enter when logging in. Follow its instructions using an app such as Google Authenticator or your phone's built-in password manager.

⚠ This is the one step where a mistake cannot be undone

When it offers you **recovery codes** — a list of one-time backup codes — **print them, or write them on paper, and keep them somewhere safe in the café** (with your business papers, not in your email).

If you ever lose your phone and you do not have these codes, **nobody can get you back into your account — not Cloudflare's support, and not us.** Your website would keep running, but no one could change it again. Two minutes with a pen now removes that risk permanently.

2. Put your website online

2.1 — Find the hosting section

In the menu on the left of the Cloudflare dashboard, click **Workers & Pages**.

SCREENSHOT

Cloudflare dashboard, left menu, “Workers & Pages” highlighted

2.2 — Create the project

1. Click **Create application**.
2. Choose the **Pages** tab.
3. Choose **Upload assets** (sometimes shown as “Drag and drop your files”).

SCREENSHOT

“Create application” → Pages tab → Upload assets

2.3 — Name it and upload

Give the project this name, exactly:

oudkempeneet-cafe

Then drag the website folder we sent you into the upload area, and click **Deploy site**. It takes under a minute.

SCREENSHOT

Project name filled in and the folder being dropped onto the upload area

2.4 — Look at your site

Cloudflare gives you a temporary address ending in `.pages.dev`. Click it. Your new website should appear.

This is your site, already online. It is not yet at your own address — that is the next two steps.

3. Add your domain to Cloudflare

3.1 — Add the site

Go to the account home (click the Cloudflare logo, top left), then click **Add a domain** — sometimes shown as “Add site”. Type your domain, without `www`:

oudkempeneetcafe.nl

SCREENSHOT

The “Add a domain” box with the domain typed in

3.2 — Choose the Free plan

You will be shown a list of plans. Scroll down and choose **Free**. Cloudflare will then look at your current settings and copy them across automatically.

SCREENSHOT

Plan selection, Free plan highlighted

3.3 — Check the copied records, then continue

You will see a list of DNS records it found. You do not need to understand them. Just confirm one line is present — a **TXT** record containing:

```
v=spf1 -all
```

If it is there, click **Continue**. If it is missing, add it before continuing, or call us.

SCREENSHOT

The scanned DNS records list with the TXT record visible

3.4 — Write down your two nameservers

Cloudflare now shows you **two addresses** that look like `anna.ns.cloudflare.com` and `rick.ns.cloudflare.com`. Every account gets a different pair, so yours will have different names.

Write both of them down. You need them in the next step.

SCREENSHOT

The two assigned Cloudflare nameservers

4. Point your domain at Cloudflare

This is the only step that happens outside Cloudflare, and it is the one that actually moves your website address. Sign in to the company you bought `oudkempeneetcafe.nl` from (**Key-Systems**, or the reseller you bought through).

Find the setting called **Nameservers**, **DNS servers**, or **NS records**. You will see these four values:

Remove these four (your current ones)

ns-cloud-e1.googledomains.com

ns-cloud-e2.googledomains.com

ns-cloud-e3.googledomains.com

ns-cloud-e4.googledomains.com

Replace them with the **two Cloudflare addresses** you wrote down in Step 3.4, and save.

Keep this page

Those four Google addresses above are your way back. If anything ever goes wrong, putting them back exactly as they were returns your site to how it is today, usually within the hour. That is why we do not cancel Squarespace until the very end.

If you cannot find the nameserver setting, take a screenshot of what you can see and send it to us — we will point at the exact box. Do not guess: changing the wrong field usually does nothing, which is confusing but harmless.

5. Connect your domain to your website

Back in Cloudflare: **Workers & Pages** → click your **oudkempeneet-cafe** project → the **Custom domains** tab → **Set up a custom domain**.

Add each of these, one at a time:

`oudkempeneetcafe.nl`

`www.oudkempeneetcafe.nl`

SCREENSHOT

Custom domains tab with both domains added and active

Cloudflare handles the security certificate — the padlock in the browser — by itself. It is usually ready within minutes and occasionally takes a few hours.

6. Check that everything works

Wait until the nameserver change has spread — usually under an hour. Then check all of this:

- `https://oudkempeneetcafe.nl` shows your new site, with a padlock
- `https://www.oudkempeneetcafe.nl` does the same
- It looks right **on your phone**, not just on a computer
- Send yourself a **test reservation** through the form and confirm the email arrives

Tell us when you have checked these. We check from our side too, before you do anything in Step 7.

7. Cancel Squarespace — last, not first

Only once Step 6 is fully working:

1. **Export your old content** as a keepsake: Squarespace → **Settings** → **Import/Export** → **Export**. Keep the file. You will probably never need it.

2. **Save any photos** from the old site that we do not already have.
3. **Cancel the subscription.** That is the last payment.

Your domain name is safe

Your domain is registered at Key-Systems, not at Squarespace. Cancelling their subscription **cannot** take your domain name with it. That is the one genuinely serious risk in a move like this, and your setup does not have it.

8. Changing your site later

When you want changes — a new menu, seasonal hours, new photos — ask us. We will make them and email you a new folder. Then:

1. Cloudflare → **Workers & Pages** → your **oudkempeneet-cafe** project
2. Click **Create a new deployment**
3. Drag the new folder in, and deploy

That is the whole process, and it is yours to run. Nothing obliges you to come back to us — we would simply like you to, on the strength of the work.

9. If something looks wrong

What you see	What to do
Site not loading, an hour after Step 4	Usually the change still spreading. Give it a few more hours before doing anything.
A security or certificate warning	Normal in the first hours while the padlock is issued. It resolves itself.
The old Squarespace site still appears	Your browser is remembering it. Try a private window, or your phone on mobile data.
Something is genuinely broken	Call us before changing anything back. If you want to revert yourself, restore the four Google nameservers from Step 4.

10. Your details — fill this in and keep it

What	Yours
Cloudflare email address	
Where the recovery codes are kept	
Your two Cloudflare nameservers	
Domain registrar login (which company)	
Date Squarespace was cancelled	